

University of North Texas at Dallas
UNT Dallas – Fall 2025
Syllabus for MGMT 3880-0072-1864: Business Ethics & Responsibility

Department of	Management	School of Business
Instructor Name:	Dr. Tyrone D. Smith, Jr.	
Office Location:	Virtually using Calendly link here .	
Email Address:	tyrone.smith@untdallas.edu Contact Information: Canvas Email is the preferred method for contacting me with questions or concerns. You may send me an email anytime that is convenient to you. Please mention the course and section number in your message. I will generally respond to email messages during the weekday (Monday through Friday). Please allow up to 3 business days/ 48-72 hours. Emails received on Friday will be responded to by the close of business on the following Monday.	
Office Hours:	Virtual by appointment. Text or email anytime, will respond within 24 hours.	
Classroom Location:	Asynchronous 100% Online	
Class Meeting Days & Times:	Internet Canvas Learning Management System	
Course Catalog Description:	Business Ethics and Social Responsibility (3 hours). A study of ethical behaviors crucial to personal and corporate success in organizations. Codes of ethics, theoretical models and managerial behavior serve as the foundation to investigate ethics, and in turn, social responsibility associated with firm theory. Various stakeholder interests and demands are analyzed as an important theme during the course.	
Prerequisites:	Not Applicable	
Required Text:	Ghillyer, A. (2025). <i>Business ethics now</i> . McGraw-Hill Education. (Connect)	
Access to Learning Resources:		UNT Dallas Library: Phone: (972) 338-1616 Website URL: http://www.untdallas.edu/library Email: library@untdallas.edu UNT Dallas Bookstore: Phone: (972) 780-3652 Website URL: http://www.untdallas.edu/bookstore E-mail: untdallas@bkstr.com
Canvas Resources Supported Browsers: ● Chrome 67 & 68 ● Firefox 60 & 61 ● Flash 29, 30 (for audio/video) ● Respondus Lockdown Browser ● Safari 10, 11 Supported Devices: ● iPhone ● Android ● Chromebook <i>Note: Tablet users can use the Canvas app</i> Screen Readers:		Getting Help with Canvas: Canvas 24/7 Phone Support for Students: 1-833-668-8634 Canvas Help Resources: Web: Canvas Student Guide For additional assistance, contact Student Assistance (UNT Dallas Distance Learning): DAL1, Room 157 phone: (972)338-5580 email: distancelearning@untdallas.edu If you are working with Canvas 24/7 Support to resolve a technical issue, make sure to keep me updated on the troubleshooting progress.

• VoiceOver (Safari) • JAWS (Internet Explorer) • NVDA (Firefox) <i>Note: There is no screen reader support for Canvas in Chrome</i>	<i>If you have a course-related issue (ex: course content, assignment troubles, quiz difficulties etc.) please contact me during office hours or by email.</i>
Course Goals/Overview: The goals of this course are to provide students with the ability to understand ethical frameworks, see real-world ethical problems, and improve the quality of managerial decisions leading to excellence in execution of business strategy. Please see Canvas home page for ancillary goals/benefits of this course.	
Learning Objectives/Outcomes: At the end of this course, students will be able to:	
1	(a) Define and distinguish different philosophical foundations of ethics and how they affect decision-making.
2	(a) Analyze, interpret contextually, and refine the students' own ethical perspectives, and that of others.
3	(a) Apply analytical tools to gain insight to situational ethics and ramifications of actions and decisions on all parties, both in a professional (business) setting or in personal interactions.
4	(a) Develop skills in recognizing paths to analyze, resolve or mediate complex ethical dilemmas.
5	(a) Recognize and contrast ethical issues from the business entities' perspective, to which they owe allegiance in a legal sense, as against their personal ethics, which may naturally differ and therefore when applied, call for differing actions and yielding different results for different affected parties.
6	(a) Know when to stand firm or yield when confronted by others with differing paradigms.

Course Outline

This schedule is subject to change by the instructor. Any changes to this schedule will be communicated in advance in class and via email and/or Canvas announcement.

Module	Schedule Weeks	Topic	Readings/Activities/Assessment
1	08/25/2025 – 08/30/2025	Chapter 1: Understanding Ethics	• Complete the Introduction Discussion # 1 post Due by 11:59PM Wednesday, August 27, 2025 • Read Chapter 1 • Review the syllabus, schedule and expectations
2	08/31/2025 – 09/06/2025	Chapter 2: Defining Business Ethics	• Read Chapter 2 • Initial Discussion # 2 Post Due by 11:59 PM Wednesday, September 3, 2025

	09/01: Labor Day		Complete Connect Chapter 2 Assignment Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, September 6, 2025
3	09/07/2025 – 09/13/2025	Chapter 3: Organizational Ethics	- Read Chapter 3 Quiz (Chapters 1 - 3) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, September 13, 2025 - Complete SmartBook Assignment (<i>Chapter 3 Organizational Ethics</i>) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, September 13, 2025
4	09/14/2025 – 09/20/2025	Chapter 4: Corporate Social Responsibility	- Read Chapter 4 - Complete Application-Based Activity (<i>Self-Assessment-Corporate Social Responsibility & HRM</i>) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, September 20, 2025
5	09/21/2025 – 09/27/2025	Chapter 5: Corporate Governance	- Read Chapter 5 - Complete Connect Chapter 5 Assignment Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, September 27, 2025 - Complete SmartBook Assignment (<i>Chapter 5 Corporate Governance</i>) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, September 27, 2025
6	09/28/2025 – 10/04/2025	Chapter Reading and Course Material	- Review chapter readings and prepare for the Midterm Exam - Initial Discussion # 3 Post Due by 11:59 PM Wednesday, October 1, 2025 Quiz (Chapters 4 - 5) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, October 4, 2025
7	10/05/2025 – 10/11/2025	Mid-Term Exam (Chapters 1-5)	Midterm Exam Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, October 11, 2025

8	10/12/2025 – 10/18/2025	Chapter 6: The Role of Government	- Read Chapter 6 - Complete Connect Chapter 6 Assignment Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, October 18, 2025
9	10/19/2025 – 10/25/2025	Chapter 7: Blowing the Whistle	- Read Chapter 7 - Complete Application-Based Activity (<i>Bus. Ethics - Exploring Corporate Culture & WB</i>) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, October 25, 2025 - Complete SmartBook Assignment (<i>Chapter 7 Blowing the Whistle</i>) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, October 25, 2025
10	10/26/2025 – 11/01/2025	Chapter 8: Ethics and Technology	- Read Chapter 8 - Complete Video-Based Discussion # 4 Post Due by 11:59 PM Wednesday, October 29, 2025 - Complete Connect Chapter 8 Assignment Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, November 1, 2025
11	11/02/2025 – 11/08/2025	Chapter 9: Ethics and Globalization	- Read Chapter 9 Quiz (Chapters 6 - 8) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, November 8, 2025 - Complete Application-Based Activity (<i>Exploring Ethics-labor Practices in Vietnam</i>) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, November 8, 2025
12	11/09/2025 – 11/15/2025	Chapter 10: Making It Stick: Doing What's Right in a Competitive Market	- Read Chapter 10 - Complete Connect Chapter 10 Assignment Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, November 15, 2025
13	11/16/2025 – 11/22/2025	Chapter 10: Making It Stick: Doing What's Right in a Competitive Market	- Continue reading chapter 10 - Complete SmartBook Assignment (<i>Chapter 10 Making It Stick: Doing What's Right In A Competitive Market</i>) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, November 22, 2025
14	11/23/2025 – 11/29/2025 11/27–28: Fall Break		Review chapter readings and course material

	<i>Thanksgiving Holiday</i>		
15	11/30/2025 – 12/06/2025		• Quiz (Chapters 9 - 10) Due by 11:59 PM Saturday, December 6, 2025 • Review Course Material and Prep for the Final Exam
16	12/07/2025 – 12/13/2025	Final Exam (Chapter 6-10)	Final Exam Due by 11:59 PM CST Thursday, December 11, 2025 (no exceptions)

Course Evaluation Methods

This course will utilize the following instruments to determine student grades and proficiency of the learning outcomes for the course: exams, quizzes, discussion posts, SmartBook Assignments, Application-Based Activities, and Chapter Assignments.

Exams - Midterm and Final

These 2 exams will contain questions testing your comprehension of and ability to integrate material associated with your textbook reading assignments.

Quizzes

Quizzes consist of material from several chapters. They are designed to check your understanding of key concepts and prepare you for exams. Students will be required to complete online quizzes. These quizzes aim to enhance comprehension and retention of the course material. They may include multiple-choice, true/false, solution-based, fill-in-the-blank- the blank and essay questions, etc

Discussion Posts

There will be *required* online threaded discussions and periodic video discussions in Canvas. The discussions will be used to encourage interaction among the students and the professor. Either the students or the professor may initiate a discussion (questions and/or comments) in the appropriate DISCUSSION BOARD FORUM pertaining to the course material, such as current news that has the potential to impact the business environment, as well as assignments in progress for the semester.

Each student will be responsible for reading the course materials by the due date and be prepared to discuss the issues intelligently. Initial discussion postings (original post response by each student) must be posted by **WEDNESDAY at 11:59 PM CST**, and all “rebuttal” postings (responses to other students’ postings) by **SATURDAY at 11:59 PM CST** of each week.

For all assignments, you must use Standard English and you must employ correct grammar, font, formatting, and punctuation. In addition, you must use [APA guidelines](#) to cite sources used in your work products.

Special Note: All weekly discussion boards are due by the module discussion board **close date** to ensure all students are actively engaging in the current week discussion modules and will not re-open for discussion boards as students are not required to go back and review and/or participate in a closed discussion board module after the discussion board deadline (no exceptions).

Please also keep in mind that because discussions are intended to serve as an intellectual interaction between you and your classmates, a flurry of last-minute posts to earn a grade is not high-quality participation and will not earn

a high score. You should not plan on waiting until the end of the week or the end of the module due date to participate in the Discussion Board. It will be more difficult to find something interesting to say that hasn't already been said, your classmates will also not have the same opportunity to interact with you, and just trying to make "the numbers" will not earn a strong score. To optimize your Discussion Board participation score, get involved in the discussions as early as possible in each module.

Please understand that any posting that contains one or more of the following characteristics will be deleted from the forum and the student will not receive credit for it. Students will be notified (via email) about the deletion of the posting and given the opportunity to post a replacement message for credit.

- Language that attacks the argument on purely emotional grounds.
- Shouting – using words in all capitals.
- Misspellings or grammar errors that compromise your ability to communicate.
- Personal experiences or feelings that are not clearly employed to make a relevant point.

The discussions will be graded for:

1. **Engaged Discussion Participation:** Students are required to log into the course learning platform and participate in each graded discussion forum by posting their own comments and responding to at least two other students. Each student should make a minimum of two contributions to the discussion forum.
2. **Quality:** Content of your contributions. Examples of quality posts include:
 - Providing additional academic information to the discussion or elaborating on/persuading against previous comments
 - Presenting explanations of concepts or methods to help fellow students
 - Providing sources for your information

Connect Chapter Assignments

Connect Chapter assignments provide structured practice with course material. They include chapter activities, quizzes, and problem sets that reinforce concepts introduced in lectures and readings. These assignments are interactive, provide instant feedback, and are designed to strengthen comprehension and application of key topics.

SmartBook Assignments

SmartBook is an adaptive, interactive e-textbook. It highlights essential content, asks guiding questions, and adjusts to your learning needs. As you work through a SmartBook assignment, the system identifies what you've mastered and what you still need to review, ensuring a personalized learning experience that improves long-term retention.

Application-Based Activities (ABAs)

ABAs are real-world, scenario-based exercises that bridge theory and practice. Each activity places you in a situation where you must analyze information, make decisions, and apply course concepts. These assignments are designed to build problem-solving skills and help you understand how the material connects to practical situations..

Grading Matrix:

Activities/Assignments	Points
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Exams 2 @ 100 points each	200
Quizzes 4 @ 35 points each	140
Coonect Chapter Assignments 5 @ 30 points each	150
Discussion/Video-Based Posts 4 @ 20 points each	80
Application-Based Activities (ABAs) 3 @ 25 points each	75
SmartBook Assignments 4 @ 15 points each	60
Total	705

GRADE DETERMINATION:

A	90–100%	635-705
B	80–89%	564-634
C	70–79%	494-563
D	60–69%	423-493
F	Below 60%	0–422

Grading Disputes: Students have five (5) business days to dispute a grade once posted to Canvas. After this deadline, the grade will be permanently recorded, and no changes will be made. This policy applies to all graded assignments, projects, exams, and quizzes.

Course-Specific Policies

Late Assignments Policy

If you do not complete the assignment by the due date, you will not receive full points. As a reminder and requirement of this online course, you should ensure you have access to a reliable Wi-Fi/internet connection at all times to access course materials. You should also actively monitor all coursework due dates and announcements on an ongoing basis. Failure to submit an assignment by the due date may result in a grade of 0 or F.

Late assignments will not be accepted. If students have extenuating circumstances, a disability accommodation letter, etc., they must communicate with the instructor in advance and not wait until the due date or after the due date. Accommodations are not retroactive. Make-up assignments are at the professor's discretion.

The instructor may require official documentation, such as a healthcare provider's note or an official university excuse, to approve late or make-up assignments. This includes written assignments, missed exams, or quizzes. Late work may be accepted if the student provides official supporting documentation for the excused absence (see above for acceptable excuses).

All assignments must be submitted by the specified due date. Late submissions are at the professor's discretion and will incur a penalty of 10 points or 10% per day. Assignments submitted more than two days after the deadline will not be accepted unless accompanied by proper documentation for an official excused absence covering the module dates. If you anticipate missing a deadline, communicate with the instructor in advance to request approval for a late submission. Approval is at the instructor's discretion and may require supporting documentation.

For assignments missed due to an excused absence, late work may be accepted by the agreed-upon date with the instructor. Work will not be accepted beyond this timeframe under any circumstances. Weekly discussion boards are an exception to this policy, as they must be completed by the module's closing date to ensure active engagement. Discussion boards cannot be reopened or retroactively completed after the deadline has passed.

Missed Exams or Quizzes

If you miss an exam or quiz, contact the instructor within 24 hours to discuss your situation. Failure to communicate within this period will result in a zero for the missed assessment.

Technical Issues

Technical issues, such as no internet/Wi-Fi connection, lost files, or corrupted files, are not valid excuses for late submissions. Students are expected to back up all work and maintain access to reliable technology and internet connections. For technical difficulties with Canvas, contact University IT Help support immediately.

General Course Policies

Active participation and quality engagement in class discussions and activities are essential and may influence borderline grades. Use your official university email for all communication with the instructor, department, or university. Non-university email accounts will not be recognized for official matters.

Academic integrity is a cornerstone of this course. Any form of plagiarism or academic dishonesty will result in serious consequences, including possible failure of the course. All work submitted must be your own.

Grades are final and will not be negotiated. While the instructor is available to discuss performance and answer questions during office hours or by appointment, requests for grade adjustments will not be considered.

Assignments must be submitted via the designated course platform, such as Canvas, and in the required format (e.g., Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint, or PDF if allowed). If the acceptable format is unclear, confirm with the instructor before submitting your work.

Instructor Communication

My virtual office hours are always open to discuss your grade, class performance, suggestions for improvement, or other professional issues. Feel free to set up an appointment. Please note that I do not “negotiate” grades. Whatever you earn will be your final grade without exception.

These policies are designed to uphold academic standards and ensure fairness. Students are encouraged to communicate proactively with the instructor regarding any concerns or anticipated issues.

Attendance and Participation Policy:

The University attendance policy is in effect for this course. Please refer to Policy 7.005 Student Attendance at <https://www.untDallas.edu/hr/upol>. I expect you to be fully present and participate during class, especially during class discussions. Please refrain from surfing the web or using your phone during class.

Assignment Policy: Assignments should be completed on time by the due date and time listed. Late assignments will receive half credit.

Exam Policy:

Exams should be taken as scheduled. No makeup examinations will be allowed except for documented emergencies (See Policy 7.005 Student Attendance at <https://www.untDallas.edu/hr/upol>).

University Policies and Procedures

Students with Disabilities (ADA Compliance):

The University of North Texas at Dallas makes reasonable academic accommodation for students with disabilities. Students seeking accommodations must first register with the Disability Services Office (DSO) to verify their eligibility. If a disability is verified, the DSO will provide you with an accommodation letter to be delivered to faculty to begin a private discussion regarding your specific needs in a course. You may request accommodations at any time, however, DSO notices of accommodation should be provided as early as possible in the semester to avoid any delay in implementation. Note that students must obtain a new letter of accommodation for every semester and must meet/communicate with each faculty member prior to implementation in each class. Students

are strongly encouraged to deliver letters of accommodation during faculty office hours or by appointment. Faculty members have the authority to ask students to discuss such letters during their designated office hours to protect the privacy of the student. For additional information see [Disability Services Office](#). You may also contact them by phone at 972-338-1777; by email at UNTDDisability@untdallas.edu or on the first floor of the Student Center.

Canvas Instructure Accessibility Statement:

University of North Texas at Dallas is committed to ensuring its online and hybrid courses are usable by all students and faculty including those with disabilities. If you encounter any difficulties with technologies, please contact our ITSS Department. To better assist them, you would want to have the operating system, web browser and information on any assistive technology being used. [Canvas Instructure Accessibility Statement is also provided.](#)

NOTE: Additional instructional technology tools, such as Turnitin, Respondus, Panopto, and publisher cartridge content (i.e. MyLab, Pearson, etc.) may NOT be fully ADA compliant. Please contact our Disability Office should you require additional assistance utilizing any of these tools.

Academic Integrity:

Academic integrity is a hallmark of higher education. You are expected to abide by the University's code of Academic Integrity policy. Any person suspected of academic dishonesty (i.e., cheating or plagiarism) will be handled in accordance with the University's policies and procedures. Refer to the UNT Dallas Academic Integrity Policy in the appropriate Catalog at <http://dallascatalog.unt.edu>.

Academic dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, cheating, plagiarizing, fabrication of information or citations, facilitating acts of dishonesty by others, having unauthorized possession of examinations, submitting work of another person or work previously used without informing the instructor, or tampering with the academic work of other students.

Web-based Plagiarism Detection: Please be aware in some courses, students may be required to submit written assignments to Turnitin, a web-based plagiarism detection service, or another method. If submitting to Turnitin, please remove your title page and other personal information.

Diversity/Tolerance Policy:

Students are encouraged to contribute their perspectives and insights to class discussions. However, offensive & inappropriate language (swearing) and remarks offensive to others of particular nationalities, ethnic groups, sexual preferences, religious groups, genders, or other ascribed statuses will not be tolerated. Disruptions which violate the Code of Student's Rights, Responsibilities, and Conduct will be referred to the Dean of Students as the instructor deems appropriate (UNT Policy 7.001 found at <https://www.untDallas.edu/hr/upol>).

Classroom Disruption:

Students are expected to engage with the instructor and other students in this class in a respectful and civil manner at all times to promote a classroom environment that is conducive to teaching and learning. Students who engage in disruptive behavior will be directed to leave the classroom. A student who is directed to leave class due to disruptive behavior is not permitted to return to class until the student meets with a representative from the Dean of Students Office. It is the student's responsibility to meet with the Dean of Students before class meets again and to provide the instructor confirmation of the meeting. A student who is directed to leave class will be assigned an unexcused absent for that class period and any other classes the student misses as a result of not meeting with the Dean of Students. The student is responsible for material missed during all absences and the

instructor is not responsible for providing missed material. In addition, the student will be assigned a failing grade for assignments, quizzes or examinations missed and will not be allowed to make up the work.

The Code of Student's Rights, Responsibilities, and Conduct (UNTD Policy 7.001 found at <https://www.untDallas.edu/hr/upol>) describes disruption as the obstructing or interfering with university functions or activity, including any behavior that interferes with students, faculty, or staff access to an appropriate educational environment. Examples of disruptive behavior that may result in a student being directed to leave the classroom include but are not limited to: failure to comply with reasonable directive of University officials, action or combination of actions that unreasonably interfere with, hinder, obstruct, or prevents the right of others to freely participate, threatening, assaulting, or causing harm to oneself or to another, uttering any words or performing any acts that cause physical injury, or threaten any individual, or interfere with any individual's rightful actions, and harassment. You are encouraged to read the Code of Student's Rights, Responsibilities, and Conduct for more information related to behaviors that could be considered disruptive.

Course Evaluations:

Student's evaluations of teaching effectiveness is a requirement for all organized classes at UNT Dallas. This short survey will be made available to you at the end of the semester via your campus email, providing you a chance to comment on how this class is taught. I will not have access to the results of the evaluations until after final grades have posted. I am very interested in the feedback I get from students, as I work to continually improve my teaching. I consider students' evaluations to be an important part of your participation in this class.

Bad Weather Policy:

Campus facilities will close and operations will be suspended when adverse weather and/or safety hazards exist on the UNTD campus or if travel to the campus is deemed dangerous as the result of ice, sleet or snow. In the event of a campus closure, the Marketing and Communication Department will report closure information to all appropriate major media by 7 a.m. That department will also update the UNTD website, Facebook and Twitter with closing information as soon as it is possible. For more information please refer to <http://www.untDallas.edu/police/resources/notifications>.

Inclement Weather and Online Classes:

Online classes may or may not be affected by campus closures due to inclement weather. Unless otherwise notified by your instructor via e-mail, online messaging, or online announcement, students should assume that assignments are due as scheduled.

Technology Assistance: In order to successfully access the materials in Canvas, UNT Dallas advises that your computer be equipped with the minimum system requirements listed on the first page of the syllabus.

If you experience difficulty accessing or using components of the course, try using Google Chrome browser. If you still experience technical difficulties, first, notify your instructor.

If the problem is still not resolved, call Distance Learning at the phone number listed on the first page of the syllabus. Also, no matter what browser you use, always enable pop-ups.

For more information see:

- UNT Dallas Canvas Technical Requirements: <https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10721>
- Canvas Instructure Support & Unsupported Operating Systems: <https://community.canvaslms.com/docs/DOC-10720>

USE OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI):

Artificial intelligence (AI) offers new opportunities and challenges in life, school, and the workplace. In higher education, the effective use of AI by students depends on the learning objectives for the course and specific assignments. In this course, the use of *generative* AI is prohibited—including but not limited to tools generating or revising text, images, code, or other content—unless an assignment's instructions specifically state otherwise. Generative AI tools, for example CoPilot and ChatGPT, offer exciting possibilities but do not take the place of the student's critical thinking, problem solving, or original ideas, writing, and research. Grammarly, as another example, offers helpful *non-generative* AI features for grammar and punctuation (ok to use) but also offers *generative* AI features to create or revise writing, change tone, etc. (not ok to use). Unless otherwise stated, the use of *generative* AI will be considered plagiarism, and consequences include failing the assignment, failing the course, and/or violation of the Academic Honesty policy and the Honor Code. If you have questions, contact your instructor to discuss the use of AI prior to submitting assignments.

If AI-generated content is used, all non-original material must be properly cited in the references section. Failure to do so may be considered a violation of academic integrity. If you are ever unsure about whether a tool is appropriate or how to cite its use, consult the instructor before submitting your work.

You can also review the APA Style guide provided in the link below:

How to cite ChatGPT

<https://apastyle.apa.org/blog/how-to-cite-chatgpt>

If you have questions, contact your instructor to discuss the use of AI prior to submitting assignments.